BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #51 · APPEARANCE AND BODY IMAGE

“I'm ugly, so I'm unlovable.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Teasing, rejection, or constant exposure to idealized images can tie lovability to looks. After a few hurtful experiences, “I’m ugly” becomes “I’m unlovable.”

What Scripture teaches

“God proves His love for us in this: While we were still sinners, Christ died for us.” His love came before our worth was visible to anyone. “Man sees the outward appearance, but the LORD sees the heart.” “I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made.” Love in Scripture is not a reward for beauty. “Love is patient, love is kind.” People who love you see far more than your face.

> *“But God proves His love for us in this: While we were still sinners, Christ died for us”* (Romans 5:8).

Also see

> “But the LORD said to Samuel, ‘Do not consider his appearance or height, for I have rejected him; the LORD does not see as man does. For man sees the outward appearance, but the LORD sees the heart.’” (1 Samuel 16:7).

> “I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well” (Psalm 139:14).

> “Love is patient, love is kind. It does not envy, it does not boast, it is not proud” (1 Corinthians 13:4).

> “The LORD your God is among you; He is mighty to save. He will rejoice over you with gladness; He will quiet you with His love; He will rejoice over you with singing” (Zephaniah 3:17).

Common self-statements

- No one could love me.
- My face makes me unlovable.
- I will be alone.
- Beauty is necessary for love.
- I am too ugly for anyone.
- I do not deserve love.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I am either beautiful or unlovable.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that no one will love me.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling ugly and concluding I am unlovable.
- Labeling: Calling myself ugly.

Challenging questions

- Who loves me, and does it depend on my looks?
- What do I love about the people dear to me?

- Who taught me that love follows beauty?
- What does God's love for me look like?
- What qualities in me are lovable?
- What would change if I believed I was loved?

Truth summary

> God loved me before I did anything. Love is not a prize for beauty. I am lovable now, and I can receive love from God and from people.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Love, By God
- Pride
- Loneliness
- Grace

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Love

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Who Am I — Casting Crowns
Being known and cared for by God rests on His love rather than personal importance.

You Say — Lauren Daigle
God's loving assessment challenges identity based only on weakness or feelings.

Is He Worthy — Andrew Peterson
Honest recognition of a broken world can lead to hope in Christ's final restoration.

Jesus Loves Me — Gaither Vocal Band
This familiar hymn places confidence in Jesus' love rather than personal strength.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I'm ugly, so I'm unlovable"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I'm ugly, so I'm unlovable." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Who loves me, and does it depend on my looks?
- ☐ What do I love about the people dear to me?
- ☐ Who taught me that love follows beauty?
- ☐ What does God's love for me look like?
- ☐ What qualities in me are lovable?
- ☐ What would change if I believed I was loved?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God loved me while I was a sinner.
- ☐ God sees my heart.
- ☐ I am fearfully and wonderfully made.
- ☐ Love is patient and kind.
- ☐ God rejoices over me.
- ☐ I am lovable.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Romans 5:8
  "But God proves His love for us in this: While we were still sinners, Christ died for us."
- ☐ 1 Samuel 16:7
  "But the LORD said to Samuel, 'Do not consider his appearance or height, for I have rejected him; the LORD does not see as man does. For man sees the outward appearance, but the LORD sees the heart.'"
- ☐ Psalm 139:14
  "I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Loved as I am: Each week, note one sign of love you received.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Romans 5:8 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God loved me while I was still a sinner.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Self-Esteem, Low" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] List your lovers. Write those who love you.
- [ ] List lovable traits. Write ten qualities that are not about looks.
- [ ] Receive love. Say thank you to compliments.
- [ ] Read Romans 5:8. Let it settle in.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I'm ugly, so I'm unlovable": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Loved as I am
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I'm ugly, so I'm unlovable.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, You loved me before I was lovely. Heal my sense of being unlovable, and let me receive love. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #52 · APPEARANCE AND BODY IMAGE

"My worth depends on how I look."

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Constant evaluation of faces and bodies, by media, peers, and ourselves, can make appearance the basis of identity. Aging and change then threaten our worth itself.

What Scripture teaches

"You made him a little lower than the angels; You crowned him with glory and honor." "God created man in His own image." "Charm is deceptive and beauty is fleeting, but a woman who fears the LORD is to be praised" (Proverbs 31:30). Worth is established by God's creation and love, not by looks. Appearance is one small part of a person.

> *"Charm is deceptive and beauty is fleeting, but a woman who fears the LORD is to be praised"* (Proverbs 31:30).

Also see

> "You made him a little lower than the angels; You crowned him with glory and honor" (Psalm 8:5).

> "So God created man in His own image; in the image of God He created him; male and female He created them" (Genesis 1:27).

> "Your beauty should not come from outward adornment, such as braided hair or gold jewelry or fine clothes, but from the inner disposition of your heart, the unfading beauty of a gentle and quiet spirit, which is precious in God's sight" (1 Peter 3:3–4).

> "But God proves His love for us in this: While we were still sinners, Christ died for us" (Romans 5:8).

Common self-statements

- I am my appearance.
- If I look bad, I am worthless.
- I need to look good to matter.
- Aging will take my value.
- I check mirrors constantly.
- I cannot go out without makeup.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I am either attractive and valuable or not.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that aging will ruin my worth.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling bad about my looks and concluding I am worthless.
- Labeling: Calling myself my appearance.

Challenging questions

- What part of my worth do I tie to my looks?
- What do I admire in others besides their looks?
- What happens when I skip checking the mirror?

- What did God declare about humanity in Genesis?
- What could I do to care for myself without obsession?
- What matters most to me at the end of life?

Truth summary

> My worth rests in God's creation, love, and calling, not in my looks. I can care for myself with gratitude and move my attention to what lasts.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Pride
- Worldly
- Gifts, Physical/Material
- God, Creator

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Thinking, Healthy

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Who Am I — Casting Crowns
Being known and cared for by God rests on His love rather than personal importance.

You Say — Lauren Daigle
God's loving assessment challenges identity based only on weakness or feelings.

Is He Worthy — Andrew Peterson
Honest recognition of a broken world can lead to hope in Christ's final restoration.

Jesus Loves Me — Gaither Vocal Band
This familiar hymn places confidence in Jesus' love rather than personal strength.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "My worth depends on how I look"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"My worth depends on how I look." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What part of my worth do I tie to my looks?
- ☐ What do I admire in others besides their looks?
- ☐ What happens when I skip checking the mirror?
- ☐ What did God declare about humanity in Genesis?
- ☐ What could I do to care for myself without obsession?
- ☐ What matters most to me at the end of life?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ I am crowned with glory and honor.
- ☐ I am made in God's image.
- ☐ Beauty is fleeting.
- ☐ God loves me as I am.
- ☐ I can care for myself kindly.
- ☐ What lasts is character.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Proverbs 31:30**
  "Charm is deceptive and beauty is fleeting, but a woman who fears the LORD is to be praised."
- ☐ **Psalm 8:5**
  "You made him a little lower than the angels; You crowned him with glory and honor."
- ☐ **Genesis 1:27**
  "So God created man in His own image; in the image of God He created him; male and female He created them."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Worth beyond looks: Each week, note one thing you did that had nothing to do with appearance.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Proverbs 31:30 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I am crowned with glory and honor.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Self-Esteem, Low" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] Notice the habit. Count how often you check the mirror.
- [ ] Limit it. Reduce one checking habit.
- [ ] Build something lasting. Invest in a skill or kindness.
- [ ] Read Proverbs 31:30. Remember what lasts.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "My worth depends on how I look": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Worth beyond looks
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~My worth depends on how I look.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I have tied my worth to my looks. Free me, teach me to see myself as You do, and help me invest in what lasts. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #53 · APPEARANCE AND BODY IMAGE

“People are always staring and judging me.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Self-consciousness can make us feel watched, especially after trauma, bullying, or visible differences. Often others are absorbed in their own concerns, but the feeling of being watched is vivid.

What Scripture teaches

“O LORD, You have searched me and known me.” Psalm 139 shows that we are always seen by God, and seen with love. “The fear of man is a snare, but whoever trusts in the LORD is set securely on high.” People notice less than we fear, and when they do stare, it often reflects curiosity or their own discomfort. God’s view of you is kind: “He will quiet you with His love.”

> *“The fear of man is a snare, but whoever trusts in the LORD is set securely on high”* (Proverbs 29:25).

Also see

> “O LORD, You have searched me and known me” (Psalm 139:1).

> “The LORD your God is among you; He is mighty to save. He will rejoice over you with gladness; He will quiet you with His love; He will rejoice over you with singing” (Zephaniah 3:17).

> “Am I now seeking the approval of men, or of God? Or am I striving to please men? If I were still trying to please men, I would not be a servant of Christ” (Galatians 1:10).

> “When I am afraid, I put my trust in You. In God, whose word I praise— in God I trust. I will not be afraid. What can man do to me?” (Psalm 56:3–4).

Common self-statements

- Everyone is looking at me.
- They are all judging.
- I cannot go anywhere without being stared at.
- I feel exposed.
- I must hide.
- They are talking about me.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing people either ignore me or judge me.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that people will stare.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling exposed and concluding that I am being judged.
- Mind reading: Calling myself the center of attention.

Challenging questions

- How often do I truly notice others’ appearance?
- What evidence do I have that people are judging?

- What do I do to avoid being seen, and what does it cost?
- What does God see when He looks at me?
- What would a small experiment look like, such as going out for ten minutes?
- Who can go with me?

Truth summary

> People notice me less than I fear, and God's gaze on me is loving. I can step out in small steps, with trusted company, and let His acceptance steady me.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Fear
- Anxiety/Worry
- Pride
- Self-Esteem, Low
- Trust

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Forgive/Forgiveness
- Pride

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

My Plan for Replacing "People are always staring and judging me"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"People are always staring and judging me." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ How often do I truly notice others' appearance?
- ☐ What evidence do I have that people are judging?
- ☐ What do I do to avoid being seen, and what does it cost?
- ☐ What does God see when He looks at me?
- ☐ What would a small experiment look like, such as going out for ten minutes?
- ☐ Who can go with me?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ The fear of man is a snare.
- ☐ The Lord knows and loves me.
- ☐ He quiets me with His love.
- ☐ I can step out gently.
- ☐ Most people are focused on themselves.
- ☐ I can trust the Lord.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Proverbs 29:25**
  "The fear of man is a snare, but whoever trusts in the LORD is set securely on high."
- ☐ **Psalm 139:1**
  "O LORD, You have searched me and known me."
- ☐ **Zephaniah 3:17**
  "The LORD your God is among you; He is mighty to save. He will rejoice over you with gladness; He will quiet you with His love; He will rejoice over you with singing."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Stepping out: Each week, note one outing and what actually happened.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Proverbs 29:25 becomes: "Sarah can write: "The Lord quiets me with His love.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Fear" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] Test the thought. Count actual stares during an outing.
- [ ] Go with someone. Take a trusted friend.
- [ ] Shorten and repeat. Build up gradually.
- [ ] Pray Psalm 56:3–4. Say it before going out.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "People are always staring and judging me": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Stepping out
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~People are always staring and judging me.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I feel watched. Quiet me with Your love, and give me courage to live among people without fear. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #54 · APPEARANCE AND BODY IMAGE

“No one could be attracted to me.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Rejection, comparisons, or scarring can make us believe romance is out of reach. We may avoid dating, friendships, or intimacy to avoid being hurt.

What Scripture teaches

“You are altogether beautiful, my darling; in you there is no flaw” (Song of Solomon 4:7) captures how love sees. “Charm is deceptive and beauty is fleeting.” “Man sees the outward appearance, but the LORD sees the heart.” Attraction is rarely about a single measure. Kindness, humor, faithfulness, and shared faith draw people. Many people are loved deeply by someone who sees them fully. God can work in His time, and meanwhile you are loved.

> *“You are altogether beautiful, my darling; in you there is no flaw”* (Song of Solomon 4:7).

Also see

> “Charm is deceptive and beauty is fleeting, but a woman who fears the LORD is to be praised” (Proverbs 31:30).

> “But the LORD said to Samuel, ‘Do not consider his appearance or height, for I have rejected him; the LORD does not see as man does. For man sees the outward appearance, but the LORD sees the heart.’” (1 Samuel 16:7).

> “I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well” (Psalm 139:14).

> “Love is patient, love is kind. It does not envy, it does not boast, it is not proud. It is not rude, it is not self-seeking, it is not easily angered, it keeps no account of wrongs. Love takes no pleasure in evil, but rejoices in the truth. It bears all things, believes all things, hopes all things, endures all things” (1 Corinthians 13:4–7).

Common self-statements

- No one will ever want me.
- I am not the type anyone falls for.
- I will be alone forever.
- I am not desirable.
- Why bother dating?
- People like me do not get loved.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing people are either attractive or not.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that no one will want me.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling unattractive and concluding that I am.
- Labeling: Calling myself undesirable.

Challenging questions

- What draws me to others besides looks?
- Who in my life has been loved deeply who did not fit a standard?
- What qualities do I bring to a relationship?

- What fears keep me from reaching out?
- What does Scripture say about how love sees?
- What first step would feel safe?

Truth summary

> Attraction is more than appearance, and love sees the whole person. I have qualities worth loving, and I can take safe steps toward friendship and connection, trusting God with the rest.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Loneliness
- Friendship
- Trust
- Will of God

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Love

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Who Am I — Casting Crowns
Being known and cared for by God rests on His love rather than personal importance.

You Say — Lauren Daigle
God's loving assessment challenges identity based only on weakness or feelings.

Is He Worthy — Andrew Peterson
Honest recognition of a broken world can lead to hope in Christ's final restoration.

Jesus Loves Me — Gaither Vocal Band
This familiar hymn places confidence in Jesus' love rather than personal strength.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "No one could be attracted to me"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"No one could be attracted to me." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What draws me to others besides looks?
- ☐ Who in my life has been loved deeply who did not fit a standard?
- ☐ What qualities do I bring to a relationship?
- ☐ What fears keep me from reaching out?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about how love sees?
- ☐ What first step would feel safe?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Love sees the whole person.
- ☐ God sees my heart.
- ☐ I am fearfully and wonderfully made.
- ☐ Beauty is fleeting; character lasts.
- ☐ I have much to offer.
- ☐ I can take a safe step.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Song of Solomon 4:7**
  "You are altogether beautiful, my darling; in you there is no flaw."
- ☐ **Proverbs 31:30**
  "Charm is deceptive and beauty is fleeting, but a woman who fears the LORD is to be praised."
- ☐ **1 Samuel 16:7**
  "But the LORD said to Samuel, 'Do not consider his appearance or height, for I have rejected him; the LORD does not see as man does. For man sees the outward appearance, but the LORD sees the heart.'"

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Open to love: Each week, note one friendly step you took.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Song of Solomon 4:7 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God sees my heart, and love sees the whole person.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Self-Esteem, Low" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- ☐ List your qualities. Write what makes you lovable.
- ☐ Widen your circle. Join a group or activity.
- ☐ Be patient. Build friendship first.
- ☐ Pray with trust. Ask God for His timing.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "No one could be attracted to me": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Open to love
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~No one could be attracted to me.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I fear no one will want me. Remind me that love sees the heart, and lead me gently toward connection in Your time. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #55 · APPEARANCE AND BODY IMAGE

"If I looked different, my life would be fine."

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

It is tempting to believe that one change in our faces, weight, or skin would solve our troubles. The thought supports endless focus on appearance and delays dealing with deeper issues such as loneliness, grief, or fear.

What Scripture teaches

"Godliness with contentment is great gain" (1 Timothy 6:6). "I have learned to be content regardless of my circumstances." "Set your minds on things above, not on earthly things." Appearance changes can be fine and helpful, but they cannot fix the heart's deeper longings. Ask what you hope the change would give you: acceptance, love, safety? God offers those in Christ. And caring for your body is wise.

> *"I am not saying this out of need, for I have learned to be content regardless of my circumstances"* (Philippians 4:11).

Also see

> "Of course, godliness with contentment is great gain" (1 Timothy 6:6).

> "Set your minds on things above, not on earthly things" (Colossians 3:2).

> "I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well" (Psalm 139:14).

> "Charm is deceptive and beauty is fleeting, but a woman who fears the LORD is to be praised" (Proverbs 31:30).

Common self-statements

- Everything would be better if I looked better.
- My problems are because of my looks.
- I will be happy after I change.
- People would like me if I looked right.
- I would be confident.
- This one thing holds me back.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing a change would fix everything or nothing would.
- Fortune telling: Predicting happiness after a change.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling insecure and concluding that appearance is the cause.
- Magical thinking: Calling my looks my problem.

Challenging questions

- What do I hope would change if my looks changed?
- Which of those could I seek now?
- What has changed before, and did it solve things?
- What do I need more than a new look: acceptance, friendship, peace?

- What does Scripture say about contentment?
- Who could help me look at the deeper issue?

Truth summary

> My life will not be fixed by a different look. The deeper longings for love, acceptance, and peace are met in God and in healthy relationships. I can care for my appearance without making it my savior.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Dissatisfaction
- Self-Esteem, Low
- Thankful
- Worldly
- Joy

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Thinking, Healthy

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Already There — Casting Crowns
God's perspective extends beyond what we can currently understand.

Thrive — Casting Crowns
Life rooted in God includes purposeful growth and joy, not merely surviving or staying busy.

If We Are the Body — Casting Crowns
The church is called to welcome and care for people rather than exclude or shame them.

Great Is Thy Faithfulness — CeCe Winans
This classic hymn recalls God's steady mercy through changing circumstances.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

My Plan for Replacing "If I looked different, my life would be fine"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"If I looked different, my life would be fine." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What do I hope would change if my looks changed?
- ☐ Which of those could I seek now?
- ☐ What has changed before, and did it solve things?
- ☐ What do I need more than a new look: acceptance, friendship, peace?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about contentment?
- ☐ Who could help me look at the deeper issue?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Godliness with contentment is great gain.
- ☐ I can learn contentment.
- ☐ I can set my mind on higher things.
- ☐ The deeper needs are met in God.
- ☐ I am fearfully and wonderfully made.
- ☐ I can seek help for deeper issues.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Philippians 4:11
  "I am not saying this out of need, for I have learned to be content regardless of my circumstances."
- ☐ 1 Timothy 6:6
  "Of course, godliness with contentment is great gain."
- ☐ Colossians 3:2
  "Set your minds on things above, not on earthly things."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

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- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
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  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Deeper needs: Each week, note one deeper need and one way you met it.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.
  For example, Philippians 4:11 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I have learned to be content regardless of my circumstances.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Dissatisfaction" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- ☐ Name the hope. Write what you want a change to give you.
- ☐ Meet it another way. Take a step toward that need.
- ☐ Talk to a counselor. Explore deeper issues.
- ☐ Thank God for your body. Name ten things it does.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "If I looked different, my life would be fine": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Deeper needs
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My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

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My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~If I looked different, my life would be fine.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I think a new look would fix me. Teach me contentment, meet my deeper needs, and help me care for myself without making appearance my hope. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.